

Lab: Develop an Elevator Pitch

Estimated time needed: 30 minutes

Introduction

An elevator pitch is a method to briefly talk about yourself and your skills in a way that the listener is interested. The elevator pitch can be from 30 seconds to a minute long. The pitch needs to be impactful!

Objective

In this lab, you will develop an elevator pitch to market yourself for a cybersecurity specialist role.

Prerequisites

- You received a template/answer sheet in Microsoft Word (MS) for this lab. You should have either MS Word installed on your computer or a Microsoft 365 online account. You can also use other word processing application software, such as Google Docs, to open Word documents.
- Review the following videos:
 - Drafting an Elevator Pitch
 - Expert Viewpoints: Elevator Pitch

Instructions

- Keeping the CTRL key pressed, click [here](#) to download the **Elevator Pitch Worksheet** MS Word document.
Note: Use the COMMAND key instead of CTRL on Mac systems.
- Review the **Elevator Pitch Template** document. The first section in this document is a three-column table. The columns include:
 - Question:** Provides the list of questions that help develop the structure of the elevator pitch. You will also find guidance on how to respond to each question.
 - Example:** Showcases the different parts of an elevator pitch. You can refer to the content in this column when developing your elevator pitch.
 - Your Input:** Use this column to enter your responses to the questions.

Question	Example	Your Input
Who are you? Start by introducing yourself with your full name and add your preferred name if you have one. Follow this with a statement about your career title and current situation.	<i>Hi, I'm Antonio Fernandes. I'm a Technical Support Engineer working toward a move as a Cybersecurity Specialist.</i>	
What do you do? Provide a few key pieces of skill or experience that set you apart and make you an interesting candidate. Don't try to list your whole resume – pick a highlight or two about your recent experience. When you've decided on your points, arrange them in a way that makes sense; you want to tell a story, not just list bullet points. Making a story out of your points quickly engages your reader's or listener's interest.	<i>Over the past two years, I've actively worked as a Technical Support Engineer with my focus on resolving customer issues and escalating the issue to the relevant teams for resolution. During this time, interactions with our cybersecurity team who performed threat analysis, vulnerability assessment, and determined the incident response strategy, got me interested in the field. I wanted to get started with a Cybersecurity Specialist role. To achieve this goal, I took some introductory classes on cybersecurity basics. Then, I got my Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) certification. The certification is my first step to stay at the forefront of industry-standard practices.</i>	
What do you want? Finish with an action request. This request could be asking for an interview, stating why you're interested in a particular position, or even just asking whether your statement covers the question they were asking. The idea is to encourage the other person to engage with you, not just listen to what you've said. This will definitely depend on the context and setting, so think of a few possible endings. While you're composing your elevator pitch, use natural-sounding language and avoid jargon. You should sound comfortable when you speak it, so remain professional, but use your own phrasing.	<i>I'm looking for a position as a Cybersecurity Specialist and your company's work in cybersecurity is very interesting. I think I can bring a lot of expertise and skills to your organization. Can we meet to discuss the open cybersecurity specialist roles you currently have?</i>	

Note: It is important that you reflect on how you want to present yourself and your aspirations before adding your input for each question.

- After documenting your responses:

- Collate the responses in the **Your Elevator Pitch** section.
 - Read the elevator pitch aloud.
 - Does the pitch sound good? If not, make adjustments.
 - Is the pitch longer than two minutes? If yes, shorten it.
4. Save this file for future use.
 5. Optionally, you can share the elevator pitch with your peers, family, and friends. Assess the feedback and update your cover letter as needed.
 6. Memorize and practice your elevator pitch.

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